



LME KNITTING PATTERN

🇳🇴 NORGE BUCKET HAT 🇳🇴

BIG BLOCK LETTERS, KNITTED IN

A summer hat in red cotton with "NORGE" in big white block letters around the front, and "RO" with waves at the back. The letters and the waves are knitted right into the hat with colourwork, not embroidered on. At the bottom the hat has a striped edge in white and blue, like a little nod to the flag.

One size in stitches, and the needle sets the width, so it fits from teens to adults. Prefer the English spelling? You can knit NORWAY instead, see the last page. A lovely summer hat for the 17th of May and everything we celebrate for Norway.

By Renate Dahl

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TIP: Read the whole pattern through once before you start, and knit a little gauge swatch first. Then the hat comes out just the right size.

BEFORE YOU START

This hat is knitted round and round on a circular needle, from the bottom up. You begin with the striped edge in white and navy blue, decrease to 110 stitches and carry on up. In the middle of the main part you knit in NORGE at the front and RO with waves at the back with colourwork, that is, right into the hat as you knit. Right at the end you bind off the top together.

WHAT YOU LEARN

- To knit in the round on a circular needle
- To knit a striped edge and decrease evenly
- To knit stripes in several colours
- To knit in a pattern with two colours (stranded colourwork with floats)
- To bind off stitches so the top comes out neat and round

HOW HARD IS IT?

A little practised. You should be able to cast on stitches, knit in the round and knit two stitches together, and want to try two colours at once. Colourwork is new to many, but we take it step by step. The letters in two colours take the most concentration, so take it easy and feel free to ask a grown-up for help there.

ONE SIZE, THE NEEDLE SETS THE WIDTH

This hat has the **same stitch count for everyone**. You cast on 130 and decrease to 110 stitches. It is the **needle** that sets how big the hat turns out:

needle 3 mm → S/M · needle 3.5 mm → L · needle 4 mm → XL

A thinner needle gives a smaller, firmer hat, a thicker needle gives a bigger one. Size L on a 3.5 mm needle is the one we have knitted and measured. Tip: Always knit a gauge swatch first, then you know your needle gives the right width.

One step at a time, and it becomes a hat in the end.

WHAT YOU NEED

YARN

DROPS Paris (100% cotton, 50 g = approx. 75 m). A thick, soft cotton yarn. For this hat we knit it firmly, on a 3 to 4 mm needle, so the hat keeps its shape nicely.

Colour	Amount
● Red (main colour)	2 to 3 balls
○ White or natural	1 ball
● Navy blue	1 ball

You can also use another thick cotton yarn (the same weight as DROPS Paris), for example Hobbii Rainbow Cotton 8/8. We knit it firmer than the label says, so the hat holds its shape. Always check your gauge!

NEEDLES AND EQUIPMENT

- A **3.5 mm circular needle**, 60 cm long (the whole hat is knitted on this). Use 3 mm for S/M and 4 mm for XL.
- **Double-pointed needles** in the same size for the top, when it gets too tight on the circular needle
- A pair of needles one size up or down if needed, so you hit the right width after the gauge swatch
- A **stitch marker** (or a little loop of yarn in another colour)
- A **tapestry needle with a blunt tip** for weaving in ends
- A little **graph paper and pencil** is handy, so you can sketch the pattern band before you knit
- Tape measure and scissors

GAUGE, THE SECRET KEY

On a 3.5 mm needle (size L), 20 stitches and about 26 rows of stockinette should make 10 × 10 cm. We knit the yarn firmer than usual, so the hat stands up well.

How to check: Cast on 24 stitches and knit stockinette (back and forth: one row knit, one row purl) until the swatch is about 12 cm tall. Lay the swatch flat and measure how many stitches there are over 10 cm in the middle.

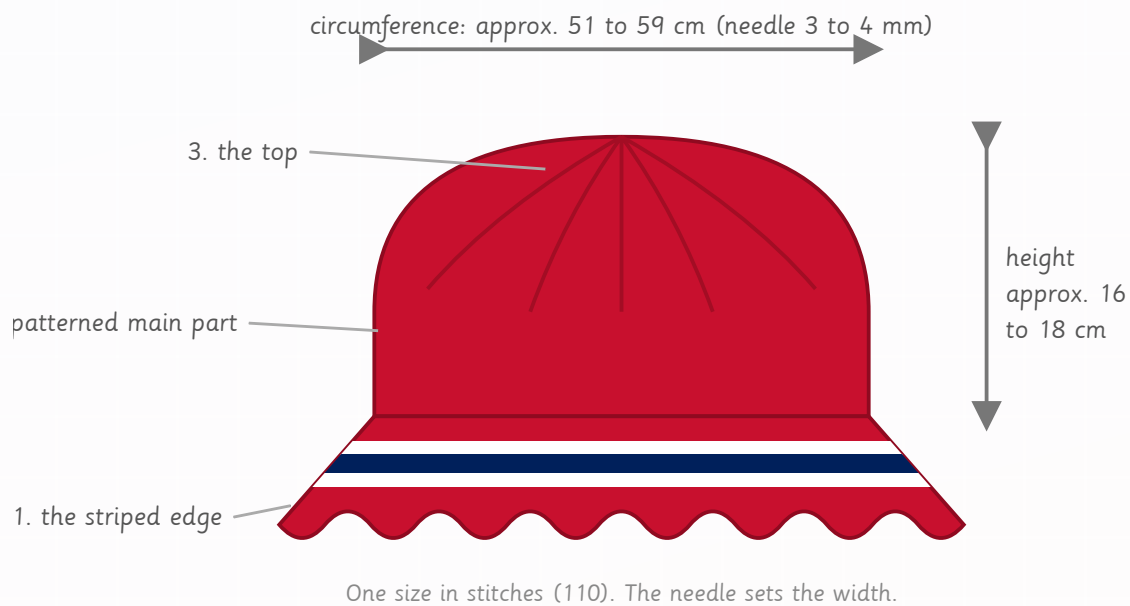
- Want it smaller (S/M)? Use a 3 mm needle.
- Want it bigger (XL)? Use a 4 mm needle.
- Hit 20 stitches on 3.5 mm? Perfect, that is size $\frac{1}{3}$, get going!

SIZES AND MEASUREMENTS

WHICH SIZE?

Measure around the head with a tape measure, right above the ears and eyebrows. Choose the needle that gives the circumference to match the head. The hat should be 3 to 4 cm smaller than the head, because knitting stretches. All the sizes have 110 stitches, it is the needle that makes the difference.

	S/M (3 mm)	L (3,5 mm)	XL (4 mm)
Fits head size	52-55 cm	56-59 cm	59-62 cm
Hat circumference	approx. 51 cm	approx. 55 cm	approx. 59 cm
Height (without brim)	approx. 16 cm	approx. 17 cm	approx. 18 cm
Stitches in the main part	110	110	110



Unsure of the size? Choose a slightly thicker needle, a bucket hat looks good sitting a little loose.

GLOSSARY

Term	Means
st	stitch
rnd	round, one whole lap around the hat
k	knit, ordinary knit stitches
k2tog	put the needle through two stitches at once and knit them as one. That gives one stitch fewer.
cast on	make the first stitches on the needle
bind off	reduce the number of stitches, so the hat gets narrower
stockinette in the round	when you knit in the round and knit every round, it comes out smooth and neat. Easier than knitting a hat back and forth!
colourwork	knitting with two colours on the same round, so a pattern appears right in the knitting
float	the yarn in the colour you are not using right now, which lies loosely on the back inside

HOW THE HAT IS BUILT UP

- 1 The striped edge:** You cast on 130 stitches in red and knit a striped edge: red, white, blue, white, red. On the last red round you decrease to 110 stitches.
- 2 The stripes in the edge:** white, navy blue and white, like a little nod to the flag.
- 3 The main part with pattern:** you knit in NORGE at the front and RO with waves at the back with two colours, and then red carries on up.
- 4 The top:** You decrease evenly in ten places, so the top comes out round like a bowl.

PART 1: THE STRIPED EDGE

Now we begin! The whole edge is knitted, that is, stockinette in the round. You knit a striped edge in the colours of the flag, and finally decrease to 110 stitches.

- 1 Cast on **130 st** in red on a 3.5 mm circular needle (3 mm for S/M, 4 mm for XL).
- 2 Put the stitch marker on the needle. It shows where the round starts, and it ends up centre back on the hat.
- 3 Lay the knitting on the table and check that the cast-on edge is not twisted around the needle. All the stitches should point the same way, like a straight railway track. Then knit the first stitch, now the ring is closed!
- 4 **The striped edge:** knit round in this order: **3 rounds red, 2 rounds white, 3 rounds navy blue, 2 rounds white**, and finally **3 rounds red**. When you change colour, just let the old yarn rest on the back.
- 5 **The decrease round (the very last red round):** Knit ***k5, k2tog*** ten times, then ***k4, k2tog*** ten times. Now you have **110 stitches**, and the edge is done.

Dropped a stitch? Take it easy. Slip the needle back in and lift it up, or ask a grown-up for help. Nothing is ruined.

CHECKPOINT

- Do you have 110 stitches on the needle after the decrease round?
- Can you see the stripes: white, blue, white, with red above and below?
- Is the edge finished? Then you are ready for part 2!

HOW TO KNIT IN THE PATTERN

Colourwork means you use two colours on the same round. You knit with red where the chart is red, and with white (or blue) where the chart shows it. The colour you are not using, you let hang loosely on the inside. The charts are on pages 9 and 10.

THE THREE THINGS YOU NEED TO KNOW

1

front



Knit each stitch in the colour the chart shows. Red is the background, white (or blue) is the pattern.

2

back



The colour you are not knitting with hangs loosely on the back. That is called a float. Keep it loose, not tight!

3

long floats



If there are more than 5 stitches between the colours, catch the long float under a stitch on the way. Then it does not dangle.

GOOD ADVICE

- Keep the floats loose. If you pull them tight, the hat bulges inward and the pattern hides. Better too loose than too tight.
- Read each row of the chart from **right to left**, from the bottom up. Then the letters come out the right way.
- Hold red on one finger and white on another, or put one down and pick up the other. Both work, choose whichever is easiest for you.
- Knit a little swatch in two colours first if you like, it makes the hat much easier.

Float = the yarn that lies behind. Loose float = a nice pattern.

PART 2: THE MAIN PART WITH PATTERN

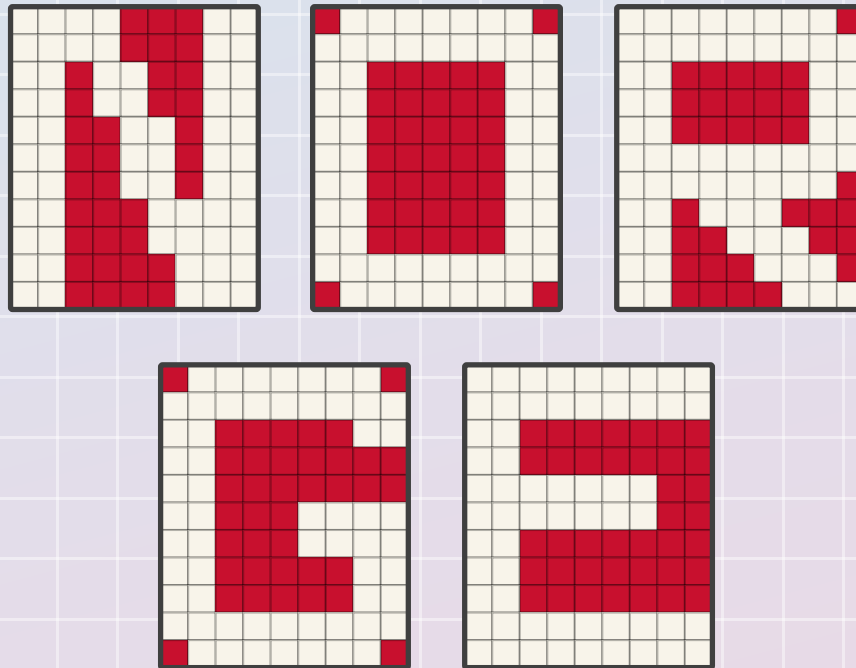
- 1 Now comes the **pattern band**, and it starts right away on the **first round after the decrease round**. Follow the charts: NORGE at the front (page 9) and RO with waves at the back (page 10). Front and back are knitted on the same rounds, with red in between and at the sides.
- 2 Everything in the band starts on the **same round** and fills **11 rounds**. NORGE and RO are 11 rounds tall. The waves are a little lower, so you place them in the middle of the band with red above and below.
- 3 When the whole pattern band is knitted (11 rounds), cut off white and navy and leave about 5 cm hanging on the inside. You weave in the ends at the end.
- 4 Carry on with red alone and knit **6 rounds** above the pattern band. Then you are ready for the top.

Always count the stitches before you start the pattern band. Getting the placement right is half the job!

CHART: NORGE

One square = one stitch. White square = knit with white. Red square = knit with red (the background). NORGE runs around the front in big block letters. Read each row from the bottom up, and from right to left. Each letter is 9 squares wide and 11 squares tall.

THE LETTERS (9 SQUARES WIDE, 11 SQUARES TALL)



WHERE ON THE HAT?

N		O		R		G		E
9 m	2 m	9 m	2 m	9 m	2 m	9 m	2 m	9 m

53 stitches wide in all

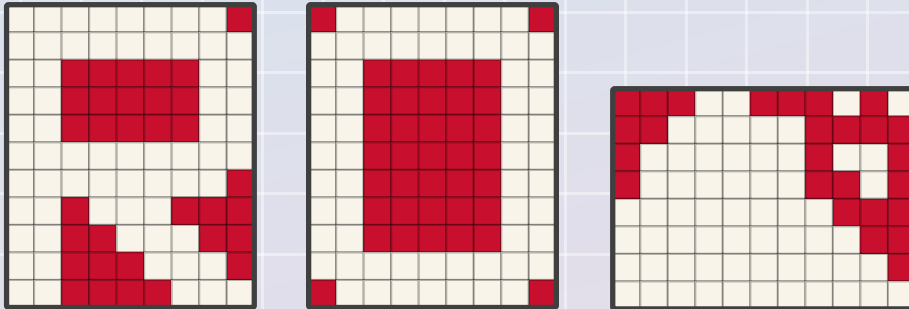
- **Across:** NORGE is centred at the front (directly opposite the stitch marker, which is at centre back). The word is 53 stitches wide, so it sits 26 to 27 stitches on each side of centre front. Leave 2 red stitches between each letter.
- **Upward:** All the letters start on the **first round** of the pattern band, and fill 11 rounds up. RO with waves at the back starts on the same round.
- You will find the full placement for all 110 stitches on the counting strip on the next page.

Would you rather the hat said NORWAY? There is a ready alternative on the last page.

CHART: RO AND WAVES AT THE BACK

At the back you knit in RO with a wave on each side. RO splits at the seam at centre back: R sits just to the right of the marker and O just to the left, so it reads RO around the back. Read each row from the bottom up, from right to left.

THE LETTERS AND THE WAVE



THE WHOLE ROUND, STITCH BY STITCH

½ RO: O 9 m	red 3 m	bølge 11 m	red 5 m	NORGE 53 m	red 5 m	bølge 11 m	red 3 m	½ RO: R 9 m	1 m
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110 stitches in all, start centre back (right end)

- **Start centre back:** Put the marker at centre back (the right end of the strip). Right after the marker you knit R (½ RO), and right before you get back to the marker you knit O. Then it reads RO around the back.
- **The waves:** one wave on each side, between RO at the back and NORGE at the front. The wave is 8 rounds tall and sits in the middle of the 11-round band, with red above and below.
- **Upward:** everything in the band starts on the first round, the same round as NORGE at the front. Between the motifs there is only red, where the background colour gets to rest.

PART 3: THE TOP

You have knitted 6 rounds in red above the pattern band. Now the hat gets narrower and narrower, until it closes at the top. You decrease in ten places on each decrease round. After decrease round 1, 2, 3 and 4 you knit an ordinary round without decreasing. From decrease round 5 you decrease on every round.

Decrease round	What to do	Left
1 (rnd 7)	*k9, k2tog* all the way around	100
	1 plain round, no decrease	100
2	*k8, k2tog*	90
	1 plain round	90
3	*k7, k2tog*	80
	1 plain round	80
4	*k6, k2tog*	70
	1 plain round	70
5	*k5, k2tog*	60
6	*k4, k2tog*	50
7	*k3, k2tog*	40
8	*k2, k2tog*	30
9	*k1, k2tog*	20
10	*k2tog* all the way around	10

The stars mean: Repeat what is between them, all the way around. When it gets too tight on the circular needle, divide the stitches onto three or four double-pointed needles and carry on just as before.

- 1 Cut the yarn, but leave about 30 cm.
- 2 Thread the end onto the tapestry needle and pass it through the last 10 stitches as you lift them off the needle.
- 3 Pull tight so the hole closes, and fasten the yarn well on the inside. The hat itself is done!

FINISHING AND CARE

RIGHT AT THE END

- 1 Weave in all loose ends on the inside of the hat: Weave them back and forth through the back of the stitches with the tapestry needle, and trim what is left.
- 2 Look over the floats on the inside. If any are too tight, you can ease them a little looser with the needle so the pattern on the outside stays even.
- 3 Rinse the hat in lukewarm water, or wash it at 40 degrees in the machine (cotton takes it just fine).
- 4 Gently squeeze out the water with a towel. Do not wring! Lay the hat flat to dry, and shape the brim into nice waves while it is wet. However it dries is how it stays.

CHECKLIST FOR A FINISHED HAT

- All ends are woven in and the floats lie loosely on the inside
- NORGE sits at the front and RO with waves at the back
- The edge is striped and the top is round
- The hat is dry and ready for summer, sea and soft ice cream

Congratulations, you have knitted your very own NORGE hat!
Show it off on the 17th of May, at the cabin and in the boat.



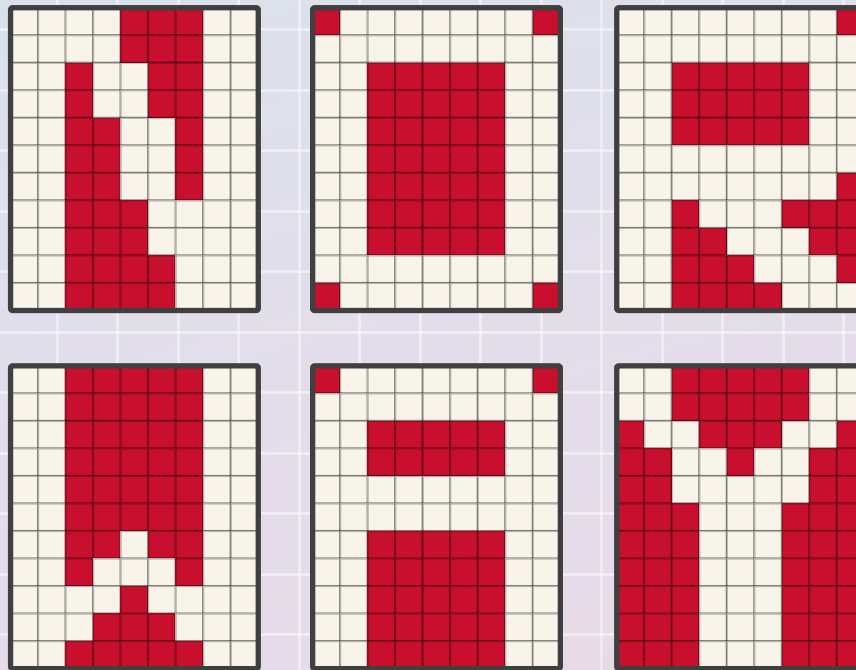
Happy summer!

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ALTERNATIVE: KNIT NORWAY

Would you rather the hat said **NORWAY** in English? You can knit NORWAY at the front instead of NORGE, and keep everything else exactly the same: RO and the waves at the back, the striped edge, the 6 red rounds above the band and the 10-place decreases at the top. NORWAY is one letter longer, so it is a little wider. Read each row from the bottom up, from right to left.

THE LETTERS (9 SQUARES WIDE, 11 SQUARES TALL)



WHERE ON THE HAT?

½ RO: O 9 m	red 3 m	wave 11 m	red 2 m	NORWAY 59 m	red 2 m	wave 11 m	red 3 m	½ RO: R 9 m	1 m
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110 stitches in all, start centre back (right end)

- **Across:** NORWAY is centred at the front, directly opposite the marker. The word is **59 stitches wide** (each letter 9 wide, 1 red stitch between), about 29 to 30 stitches on each side of centre front.
- **To make it fit:** leave only **2 red stitches** (instead of 5) between each wave and the word. The whole round is then: O (9) + 3 red + wave (11) + 2 red + NORWAY (59) + 2 red + wave (11) + 3 red + R (9) + 1 red seam = 110 stitches.
- **Upward:** the letters start on the same first round of the band and fill 11 rounds, exactly like NORGE. RO and the waves at the back are unchanged.